Disclaimer :

The Competition DG makes the information provided by the notifying parties in section 1.2 of Form CO available to the public in order to increase transparency. This information has been prepared by the notifying parties under their sole responsibility, and its content in no way prejudges the view the Commission may take of the planned operation. Nor can the Commission be held responsible for any incorrect or misleading information contained therein.

M.11956 – UMG / DOWNTOWN

SECTION 1.2

Description of the concentration

This notification concerns the proposed acquisition by Universal Music Group N.V. (UMG) of sole control over Downtown Music Holdings LLC (Downtown) within the meaning of Article 3(1), point (b) EUMR.

The concentration is effected by purchase of shares pursuant to a Membership Interest Purchasing Agreement entered into by the parties on 16 December 2024.

UMG is a global company incorporated in the Netherlands and listed on Euronext Amsterdam owning and operating businesses engaged in wholesale recorded music, music publishing, merchandising, and audio-visual content. On closing, Downtown will be incorporated into Virgin Music Group, a standalone division within UMG, providing A&L services to third-party record labels and artists.

Downtown (which is ultimately controlled by Myers Business Trust) is a global independent rights management and music services company, headquartered in New York, USA, active in the provision of A&L services, relatively limited publishing services focused on royalty collection, and certain ancillary services.